

CFMI
CONSUMING FIRE
MINISTRIES INTERNATIONAL

**TEACHINGS FOR HOME GROUP**

**LESSON | One: TEMPTATIONS AND SIN**

**Teacher's Notes**

- Pray before your read.
- Go through the whole hand-out before the meeting.
- Allow the teaching to change you first before you teach others.
- Begin the Bible study meeting with prayer.
- Ask questions to encourage participation.

"Blessed is the man that endureth temptation: for when he is tried, he shall receive the crown of life, which the Lord hath promised to them that love him. Let no man say when he is tempted, I am tempted of God: for God cannot be tempted with evil, neither tempteth he any man: But every man is tempted, when he is drawn away of his own lust, and enticed. Then when lust hath conceived, it bringeth forth sin: and sin, when it is finished, bringeth forth death." (Jas 1:12-15 KJV)

Ask the congregation: What do you understand from these verses?

**What is temptation?**

We will ALWAYS face the challenge of being "enticed, seduced, allured or persuaded" to do something wrong and evil, by the promise of "temporary pleasure or gain." Temptation is the desire to do something, especially something wrong or unwise. Temptation is not sinful. Jesus was tempted (Mark 1:13; Luke 4:1-13), but He never sinned (Hebrews 4:15). Sin takes place when we are overcome by temptations. It becomes sin when we allow the temptation to become action in our minds and in deeds. Lust, for example, is sin even though it may never be acted upon (Matthew 5:28). Covetousness, pride, greed, and envy are all sins of the heart; even though they may not be apparent to anyone else, they are still sin (Romans 1:29; Mark 7:21-22). When we give in to the temptation to entertain such thoughts, they take root in our hearts and defile us (Matthew 17:19).

Temptation is not the cause of trouble or wrongdoing. It just presents us with a choice. We should not blame our wrong doing on temptations: - (such as saying, "I wouldn't have done it if I had not been tempted!") Adam blamed Eve, and Eve blamed the Serpent, but NEITHER of them had the courage to say, "I take FULL responsibility for what I did."

Temptations come from two spheres, from within and from without.



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**Temptations Within Us**

**"Blessed is the man that endureth temptation: for when he is tried, he shall receive the crown of life, which the Lord hath promised to them that love him. Let no man say when he is tempted, I am tempted of God: for God cannot be tempted with evil, neither tempteth he any man: But every man is tempted, when he is drawn away of his own lust, and enticed. Then when lust hath conceived, it bringeth forth sin: and sin, when it is finished, bringeth forth death."** (Jas 1:12-15 KJV) There is a battle within us in our desires and out thought processes. We can be tempted from within towards people. Temptations toward people may not be sexual in nature, they may be anger, resentment, bitterness, hatred, slander etc.

**Temptations from without/outside**

Temptations can come from Satan, his demons and his agents. We can be tempted in a WIDE VARIETY of ways – including temptations that are oriented toward possessions, or positions of power and prestige pride), as well as temptations toward people.

**Can I be tempted beyond my ability?**

**"No temptation has overtaken you that is not common to man. God is faithful, and he will not let you be tempted beyond your ability, but with the temptation he will also provide the way of escape, that you may be able to endure it."** (1Corinthians 10:13 ESV)

**Major areas of Temptations**

**"Do not love the world or the things in the world. If anyone loves the world, the love of the Father is not in him. For all that is in the world--the desires of the flesh and the desires of the eyes and pride in possessions--is not from the Father but is from the world. And the world is passing away along with its desires, but whoever does the will of God abides forever."** (1John 2:15-17 ESV)

1. Self - your own desires
2. Satan – your adversary
3. The world – the system of the world under satan's control

**How to overcome temptations?**

- **Know the source or cause of temptation**



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**"Let no one say when he is tempted, "I am being tempted by God," for God cannot be tempted with evil, and he himself tempts no one."** (James 1:13-14 ESV)

It is important to know who is responsible for the temptation and where it is coming from. The approach you will use to overcome the temptation depends on the nature of the temptation.

- **Pray against temptations**

"And when he came to the place, he said to them, "Pray that you may not enter into temptation."" (Luke 22:40 ESV)

- **Reject the first suggestion to sin**

The best defense against giving in to temptation is to flee at the first suggestion. Joseph is a great example of someone who did not allow temptation to become sin (Genesis 39:6-11).

"So Joseph found favor in his sight and attended him, and he made him overseer of his house and put him in charge of all that he had. From the time that he made him overseer in his house and over all that he had the LORD blessed the Egyptian's house for Joseph's sake; the blessing of the LORD was on all that he had, in house and field. So he left all that he had in Joseph's charge, and because of him he had no concern about anything but the food he ate. Now Joseph was handsome in form and appearance. And after a time his master's wife cast her eyes on Joseph and said, "Lie with me." But he refused and said to his master's wife, "Behold, because of me my master has no concern about anything in the house, and he has put everything that he has in my charge. He is not greater in this house than I am, nor has he kept back anything from me except yourself, because you are his wife. How then can I do this great wickedness and sin against God?" And as she spoke to Joseph day after day, he would not listen to her, to lie beside her or to be with her. But one day, when he went into the house to do his work and none of the men of the house was there in the house, she caught him by his garment, saying, "Lie with me." But he left his garment in her hand and fled and got out of the house. And as soon as she saw that he had left his garment in her hand and had fled out of the house, she called to the men of her household and said to them, "See, he has brought among us a Hebrew to laugh at us. He came in to me to lie with me, and I cried out with a loud voice. And as soon as he heard that I lifted up my voice and cried out, he left his garment beside me and fled and got out of the house." Then she laid up his garment by her until his master came home, and she told him the same story, saying, "The Hebrew servant, whom you have brought among us, came in to me to laugh at me. But as soon as I lifted up my voice and cried, he left his garment beside me and fled out of the house." As soon as his master heard the words that his wife spoke to him, "This is the way your servant treated me," his anger was kindled. And Joseph's master took him and put him into the prison, the place where the king's prisoners were confined, and he was there in prison. But the LORD was with Joseph and showed him steadfast love and gave him favor in the

sight of the keeper of the prison. And the keeper of the prison put Joseph in charge of all the prisoners who were in the prison. Whatever was done there, he was the one who did it." (Gen 39:4-22 ESV)

Ask the congregation this question: What do you learn from this passage concerning temptations?

- **Run away from the temptation, avoid or do not put yourself into the area of temptation**

**"Flee from sexual immorality. Every other sin a person commits is outside the body, but the sexually immoral person sins against his own body. Or do you not know that your body is a temple of the Holy Spirit within you, whom you have from God? You are not your own, for you were bought with a price. So glorify God in your body."** (1 Corinthians 6:18-20 ESV)

God promises to provide a "way of escape" when we are tempted (1 Corinthians 10:13), but sometimes that way is to avoid the situation altogether. "Flee the evil desires of youth" (2 Timothy 2:22). Temptations are better avoided than resisted. It is good to avoid the situation altogether if it can be avoided or to run away from the situation than to try to talk, reason, justify, explain or quarrel.

- **Remain steadfast during temptations**

**"Blessed is the man who remains steadfast under trial, for when he has stood the test he will receive the crown of life, which God has promised to those who love him."** (James 1:12 ESV )

- **Resist the tempter or source of temptation by submitting to God**

"Submit yourselves therefore to God. Resist the devil, and he will flee from you." (James 4:7 KJV)

- **Walk in the Spirit**

"[This] I say then, Walk in the Spirit, and ye shall not fulfil the lust of the flesh." (Galatians 5:16 KJV)

- **Depend on Christ to overcome**

**"For in that he himself hath suffered being tempted, he is able to succour them that are tempted."** (Hebrews 2:18 KJV)